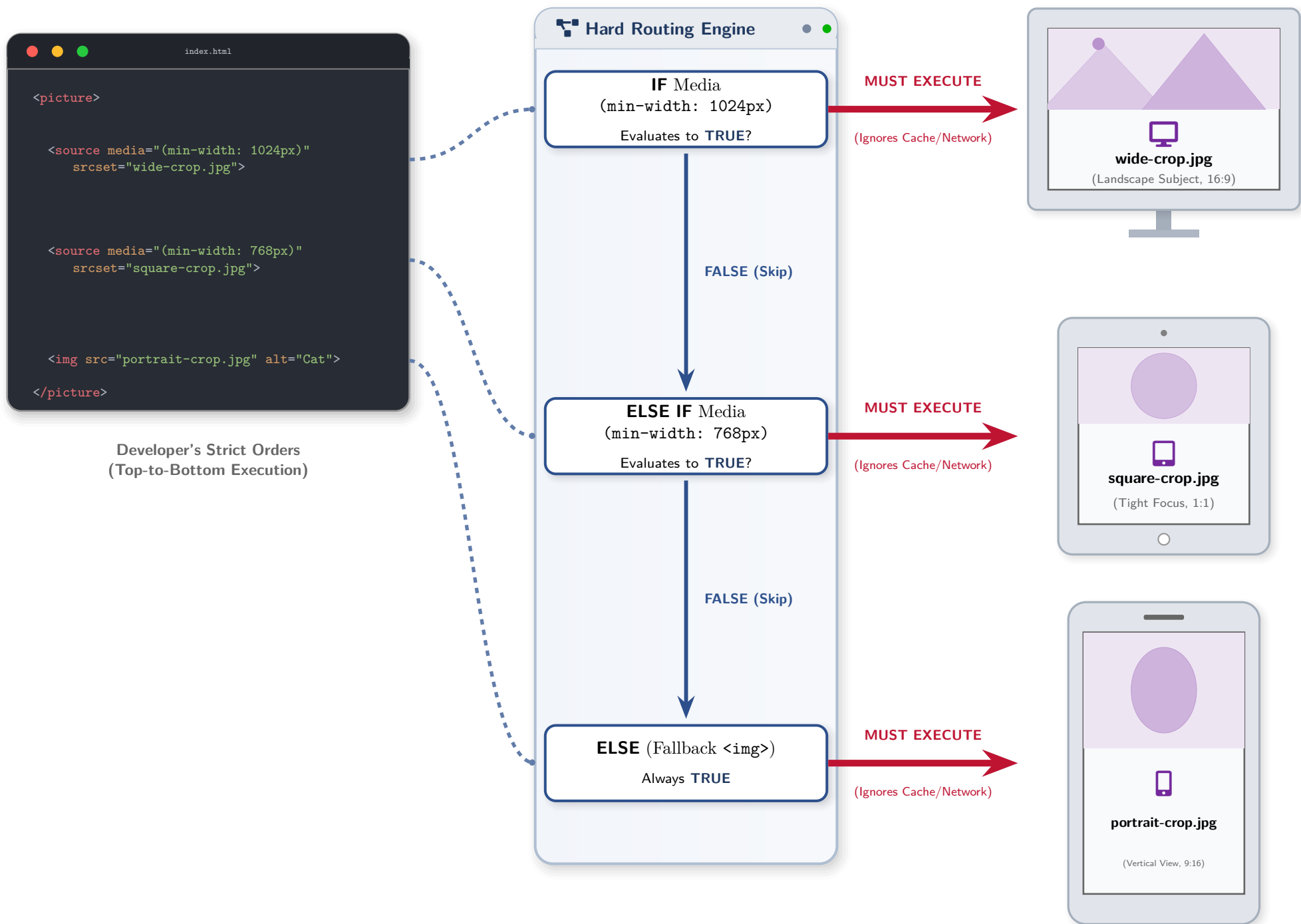


<picture>: The Mandatory "Directive"

Art Direction: The Browser is Stripped of Autonomy



🚀 **The Mandatory Directive (Art Direction):** The <picture> element acts as a strict, dictatorial IF/ELSE router. Once a <source> media query evaluates to TRUE, the browser is forcibly stripped of its heuristic autonomy. It *must* download and render that exact source. It cannot choose a smaller fallback to save bandwidth. This rigidity guarantees that the correct crop is rendered (e.g., ensuring a subject's head isn't cropped off on narrow mobile screens) exactly when intended.